

Acceptable Use Policy

1. Purpose

This policy establishes the rules governing acceptable use of Summit IT Services technology resources, including computing devices, networks, software, and data systems. The intent is to protect Summit IT Services, its employees, and its clients from harm arising from inappropriate, unlawful, or insecure use of company-provided or company-connected technology.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All employees, contractors, temporary workers, interns, and third-party vendors with access to Summit IT Services systems.
- All company-owned or company-managed devices (Dell Latitude 7440 laptops, MacBook Pro 14" endpoints, mobile devices enrolled in Intune or Jamf Pro).
- All networks operated by or on behalf of Summit IT Services, including the Summit-Corp wireless network, wired office networks, and VPN-connected sessions via GlobalProtect.
- All Summit IT Services accounts (Okta SSO, Microsoft 365, Slack, Zoom, OneDrive, SharePoint, 1Password, SummitDesk).
- Personal devices (BYOD) that access Summit IT resources (refer also to POL-004).

3. Policy Statements

3.1 General Use

3.1.1 Company technology resources are provided primarily for business purposes. Incidental personal use is permitted provided it does not: (a) interfere with job duties, (b) consume excessive bandwidth or storage, (c) violate any provision of this policy, or (d) create legal or reputational risk for Summit IT Services.

3.1.2 Employees must not use company resources to access, transmit, store, or display content that is obscene, harassing, discriminatory, or illegal under applicable federal or state law.

3.1.3 All activity on company systems is subject to monitoring. Users have no expectation of privacy on company-owned devices or networks. Monitoring may include, but is not limited to, email content, web browsing history, endpoint telemetry via CrowdStrike Falcon, and VPN session logs.

3.1.4 Employees must lock their workstation (Windows: **Win+L**; macOS: **Ctrl+Cmd+Q**) whenever leaving it unattended, even briefly.

3.1.5 Employees must not share their Okta credentials, 1Password master password, or any system credentials with other employees, contractors, or family members under any circumstances.

3.2 Network Use

3.2.1 Corporate devices must connect to the Summit-Corp WPA2-Enterprise Wi-Fi network using Okta credentials when in the office. The Summit-Guest network is for visitors only and must not be used by employees for business work.

3.2.2 GlobalProtect VPN must be active when accessing any Summit IT internal application or system from outside the office network. Split-tunneling that bypasses VPN for corporate destinations is prohibited unless explicitly approved by IT Engineering.

3.2.3 Employees must not connect company devices to untrusted public Wi-Fi hotspots without GlobalProtect VPN active and protecting all traffic.

3.2.4 Installation of personal Wi-Fi routers, rogue access points, or network switches in office locations is prohibited.

3.2.5 Peer-to-peer (P2P) file-sharing applications (torrents, etc.) are prohibited on company devices and networks.

3.3 Software and Applications

3.3.1 Only software approved by IT and distributed via Company Portal (Intune/Windows) or Self Service (Jamf Pro/macOS) may be installed on company devices without an approved exception. See POL-007 for the full Software Installation & Licensing Policy.

3.3.2 Employees must not disable, uninstall, or interfere with CrowdStrike Falcon, Okta Verify, GlobalProtect, or any other security agent installed on company devices.

3.3.3 Browser extensions must be limited to those present in the IT-approved extension list published on the internal IT portal at <https://help.summitit.com>. Extensions with permissions to read all site data require L2 Desktop approval before installation.

3.3.4 Employees must not use company devices to circumvent content filters, firewalls, or DNS security controls, including through proxy services, anonymizing browsers, or Tor.

3.4 Data and Intellectual Property

3.3.1 Company data must be stored in approved platforms: OneDrive for Business, SharePoint, or other IT-sanctioned repositories. Personal cloud storage (consumer Google Drive, Dropbox, iCloud personal, etc.) must not be used for company data.

3.4.2 Employees must not copy, share, or reproduce proprietary information, trade secrets, client data, or licensed software in violation of Summit IT Services confidentiality obligations or applicable law.

3.4.3 Printing of confidential or sensitive documents must follow the Data Classification & Handling Policy (POL-005). Documents must be retrieved from PaperCut-managed MFPs immediately and not left in output trays.

3.5 Email and Communications

3.5.1 The Microsoft 365 email system (@summitit.com) is for business use. Refer to POL-008 for detailed Email & Communications Policy requirements.

3.5.2 Employees must not send confidential or client data to personal email accounts.

3.5.3 Phishing, spam, and suspicious messages must be reported using the **Report Phishing** button in Outlook or by forwarding to soc@summitit.com.

3.6 Social Media

3.6.1 Employees may not represent themselves as official spokespersons for Summit IT Services on personal social media without prior written authorization from Marketing and Legal.

3.6.2 Confidential company or client information must never be shared on social media platforms.

3.7 Prohibited Activities

The following activities are expressly prohibited on all Summit IT resources:

Category	Examples
Unauthorized access	Attempting to access systems, accounts, or data beyond one's authorized scope
Malware and hacking tools	Installing keyloggers, port scanners, exploit frameworks, or packet sniffers
Illegal content	Accessing, downloading, or distributing illegal material
Cryptocurrency mining	Using company compute or electricity for crypto mining
Unauthorized recording	Recording meetings or calls without consent of all participants where required by law
Bypassing security	Disabling Falcon, removing MDM profile, circumventing MFA
License violation	Using unlicensed software or violating SaaS terms of service
Harassment	Using IT systems to bully, intimidate, or harass colleagues or third parties

4. Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
All Employees	Read, understand, and comply with this policy; report violations
Managers / Supervisors	Enforce policy within their teams; report suspected violations to IT
IT Service Desk (L1)	First point of contact for policy questions; escalate violations
IT Security & Compliance	Own, maintain, and enforce this policy; conduct investigations
L3 Engineering	Implement technical controls enforcing this policy
HR	Partner with IT Security on disciplinary proceedings
Legal	Advise on regulatory requirements and lead formal investigations

5. Enforcement & Consequences

Violations of this policy may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment or contract, and referral to law enforcement where applicable. Consequences are assessed considering the severity, intent, and impact of the violation:

- **Minor violations** (e.g., using unapproved browser extension, personal cloud storage): Written warning, mandatory security awareness training.
- **Moderate violations** (e.g., sharing credentials, ignoring repeated policy reminders): Formal written warning, temporary access restrictions, additional training.
- **Severe violations** (e.g., data exfiltration, disabling security tools, unauthorized system access): Immediate suspension of access, HR investigation, potential termination, possible legal action.

6. Exceptions

Requests for exceptions to this policy must be submitted via SummitDesk at <https://help.summitit.com> using the "Policy Exception Request" template. Exceptions require:

1. Written business justification.
2. Risk assessment completed by IT Security & Compliance.
3. Approval from the employee's department head and the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO).
4. A defined expiration date (maximum 12 months); exceptions must be renewed annually.

Approved exceptions are documented in the IT GRC system. No exception is valid retroactively.

7. Related Documents

- POL-002 - Password & Authentication Policy
- POL-003 - Multi-Factor Authentication Policy
- POL-004 - BYOD & Mobile Device Policy
- POL-005 - Data Classification & Handling Policy
- POL-006 - Remote Work IT Policy
- POL-007 - Software Installation & Licensing Policy
- POL-008 - Email & Communications Policy
- REF-0001 - Summit IT Environment Standards

8. Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
1.0	2021-03-01	IT Security	Initial policy release
2.0	2022-09-15	IT Security	Added social media and crypto mining clauses
3.0	2024-02-01	IT Security & Compliance	Aligned to CrowdStrike Falcon, GlobalProtect, Okta stack; added BYOD reference
3.1	2025-01-10	IT Security & Compliance	Added generative AI reference; updated prohibited activity table
3.2	2026-01-15	IT Security & Compliance	Annual review; clarified PaperCut printing requirements; minor language updates